

D915

Resource Management and Performance

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A unit that recently switched to 12-hour shifts needs 18,720 worked nursing hours a year. Each FTE is paid 2,080 hours, of which 1,872 are worked; the rest is PTO and education. The nurse manager has a doctorate. How many FTEs does the unit need?

- A. 9
- B. 450
- C. 11
- D. 10

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A department has 12 FTEs, each paid 2,080 hours a year, with 8% nonproductive time. About how many worked hours does it produce per year?

- A. 24,960
- B. 26,957
- C. 22,963
- D. 1,914

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A hospital that recently completed a merger wants an early-warning KPI for future nurse turnover. The COO rides motorcycles on weekends. Which is a leading indicator?

- A. Last year's cost of replacing nurses
- B. Quarterly staff engagement survey scores
- C. Any KPI, since all KPIs predict the future equally
- D. Last year's annual turnover rate

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A 90-bed rural hospital known for its community garden compares its cost per adjusted discharge to the average for 600-bed urban academic medical centers and concludes it is very efficient. Its board meets quarterly. What is the main flaw?

- A. It should use raw discharges instead of adjusted ones
- B. The board should meet monthly to review benchmarks
- C. The comparison group is not comparable; it should benchmark against similar hospitals with case-mix adjustment
- D. Cost per discharge is never a valid KPI

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A manager in a city with a busy convention center is planning a new outpatient center and maps stakeholders. The state health planning agency can approve or block the project but has little interest in daily operations. The agency's director is new. How should the manager handle this stakeholder?

- A. Keep informed
- B. Keep satisfied
- C. Monitor only
- D. Manage closely

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Front-line nurses have high interest in a new unit's layout but little formal power over its approval. Where do they fall on the grid, and what approach fits?

- A. Keep satisfied
- B. Monitor only
- C. Manage closely
- D. Keep informed, and involve them in design input

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A med-surg unit with a new charge-nurse rotation logged 6,300 worked nursing hours in a month with 900 patient days. Its budget target is 7.5 hours per patient day. The unit's break-room vending machine was just replaced. What is its actual HPPD, and how does it compare?

- A. 0.14
- B. 7.5, exactly on target
- C. 7.0, which is over budget
- D. 7.0, below the 7.5 target

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A unit budgets 8.0 hours per patient day and expects 1,200 patient days next month. How many worked hours are budgeted?

- A. 1,208
- B. 150
- C. 9,600
- D. It cannot be known without each shift's staffing grid

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A hospital's linen vendor, which is family-owned and sponsors a local 5K, has a contract requiring 98% on-time deliveries. This quarter, 470 of 500 deliveries arrived on time. What does the vendor scorecard show?

- A. 94%, below the 98% requirement, which triggers the contract's corrective steps
- B. 94%, exceeding the 98% target
- C. Meets expectations, because it is a trusted local sponsor
- D. 98%, meeting the requirement

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A hospital with a new rooftop garden is rolling out a badge-access system. The RACI chart lists the IT director, the facilities director, and the security manager each as “A” for installation. The CFO is a former engineer. What is the problem?

- A.** More people should be marked Accountable
- B.** There should be exactly one Accountable person for the task
- C.** There are too many people marked Responsible
- D.** The CFO should be Accountable because of his engineering background

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In a RACI chart, a nurse educator must be asked for input before a new policy is finalized, but she does not do the work or approve it. What is her role?

- A.** Consulted
- B.** Informed
- C.** Accountable
- D.** Responsible

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A hospital that recently added a helicopter service tracks the percentage of staff completing new-skills training. Its chief strategy officer has published two books. Which balanced scorecard perspective does this measure belong to?

- A.** Learning and growth
- B.** Customer
- C.** Financial, since every metric ultimately affects money
- D.** Internal process

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A unit ~~that recently switched to 12-hour shifts~~ needs 18,720 worked nursing hours a year. Each FTE is paid 2,080 hours, of which 1,872 are worked; the rest is PTO and education. ~~The nurse manager has a doctorate.~~ How many FTEs does the unit need?

Target word: FTEs needed **Decides:** $18,720 \div 1,872$ worked hours per FTE.

A	Dropped element	Divides by 2,080 paid hours and drops the nonproductive time.
B	Wrong stem number	Divides by a 40-hour week instead of annual hours per FTE.
C	Confusion set	Adds 10% for PTO again after already using worked hours.
D	Correct	$18,720 \div 1,872 = 10$ FTEs.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

A department has 12 FTEs, each paid 2,080 hours a year, with 8% nonproductive time. About how many worked hours does it produce per year?

Target word: worked hours **Decides:** $12 \times 2,080 \times 0.92$.

A	Dropped element	Drops the 8% nonproductive time.
B	Inverted operation	Adds 8% instead of subtracting it.
C	Correct	$12 \times 2,080 = 24,960$ paid; $\times 0.92 = 22,963$ worked.
D	Confusion set	That is worked hours for one FTE, not twelve.

3. Answer B Concept 2

A hospital ~~that recently completed a merger~~ wants an early-warning KPI for future nurse turnover. ~~The COO rides motorcycles on weekends.~~ Which is a leading indicator?

Target word: leading indicator **Decides:** Changes before turnover happens.

A	Adjacent category	A lagging financial result, not an early signal.
B	Correct	Falling engagement signals turnover before people leave.
C	Absolute language	Only some indicators move ahead of outcomes.
D	Confusion set	That is a lagging result.

4. Answer C Concept 3

A 90-bed rural hospital ~~known for its community garden~~ compares its cost per adjusted discharge to the average for 600-bed urban academic medical centers and concludes it is very efficient. ~~Its board meets quarterly.~~ What is the main flaw?

Target word: benchmarking flaw **Decides:** The peer group is not comparable.

A	Inverted operation	Adjustment improves comparability; removing it makes things worse.
B	Camouflage	Meeting frequency does not fix the peer group.
C	Correct	Valid benchmarks use like peers and adjust for differences.
D	Absolute language	It is a common KPI when compared properly.

5. Answer B Concept 4

A manager ~~in a city with a busy convention center~~ is planning a new outpatient center and maps stakeholders. The state health planning agency can approve or block the project but has little interest in daily operations. ~~The agency's director is new.~~ How should the manager handle this stakeholder?

Target word: grid strategy **Decides:** High power, low interest.

A	Inverted operation	That is for low power and high interest, the reverse.
B	Correct	High power with low interest calls for keeping them satisfied.
C	Dropped element	Drops the agency's power to block the project.
D	Confusion set	That is for high power and high interest.

6. Answer D Concept 4 • transfer

Front-line nurses have high interest in a new unit's layout but little formal power over its approval. Where do they fall on the grid, and what approach fits?

Target word: grid strategy **Decides:** Low power, high interest.

A	Inverted operation	That is for high power and low interest.
B	Dropped element	Drops their high interest.
C	Confusion set	That is for stakeholders with both high power and high interest.
D	Correct	Low power and high interest calls for keeping them informed.

7. Answer D Concept 5

A med-surg unit ~~with a new charge nurse rotation~~ logged 6,300 worked nursing hours in a month with 900 patient days. Its budget target is 7.5 hours per patient day. ~~The unit's break room vending machine was just replaced.~~ What is its actual HPPD, and how does it compare?

Target word: actual HPPD vs. target **Decides:** $6,300 \div 900$.

A	Inverted operation	Divides patient days by hours.
B	Wrong stem number	Repeats the target instead of calculating.
C	Confusion set	Lower HPPD than target means under, not over, budget on hours.
D	Correct	$6,300 \div 900 = 7.0$, fewer hours per patient day than budgeted.

8. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

A unit budgets 8.0 hours per patient day and expects 1,200 patient days next month. How many worked hours are budgeted?

Target word: budgeted hours **Decides:** $8.0 \times 1,200$.

A	Confusion set	Adds the numbers instead of multiplying.
B	Inverted operation	Divides patient days by HPPD instead of multiplying.
C	Correct	$8.0 \times 1,200 = 9,600$ worked hours.
D	Adjacent category	HPPD budgeting needs only the target and patient days.

9. Answer A Concept 6

A hospital's linen vendor, ~~which is family owned and sponsors a local 5K~~, has a contract requiring 98% on-time deliveries. This quarter, 470 of 500 deliveries arrived on time. What does the vendor scorecard show?

Target word: scorecard result **Decides:** $470 \div 500 = 94\%$ vs. 98%.

A	Correct	$470 \div 500 = 94\%$.
B	Inverted operation	Reads the comparison backward.
C	Camouflage	Relationship does not replace contracted metrics.
D	Wrong stem number	Reports the target instead of actual performance.

10. Answer B Concept 7

A hospital ~~with a new rooftop garden~~ is rolling out a badge-access system. The RACI chart lists the IT director, the facilities director, and the security manager each as "A" for installation. ~~The CFO is a former engineer.~~ What is the problem?

Target word: RACI problem **Decides:** Multiple Accountable roles.

A	Inverted operation	That worsens the problem.
B	Correct	Shared accountability blurs who owns the result.
C	Confusion set	The chart's problem is multiple A's, not R's.
D	Camouflage	His background is irrelevant to the RACI rule.

11. Answer A Concept 7 · transfer

In a RACI chart, a nurse educator must be asked for input before a new policy is finalized, but she does not do the work or approve it. What is her role?

Target word: RACI role **Decides:** Two-way input before the decision.

A	Correct	Consulted people give input before decisions.
B	Confusion set	Informed is one-way notice after the decision.
C	Inverted operation	Accountable owns and approves the result.
D	Adjacent category	Responsible means doing the work.

12. Answer A Concept 8

A hospital ~~that recently added a helicopter service~~ tracks the percentage of staff completing new-skills training. ~~Its chief strategy officer has published two books.~~ Which balanced scorecard perspective does this measure belong to?

Target word: perspective **Decides:** Workforce skill development.

A	Correct	Staff skills and training are learning and growth measures.
B	Adjacent category	Customer covers patient satisfaction and access.
C	Absolute language	The scorecard separates perspectives on purpose.
D	Confusion set	Internal process covers how well work flows, such as turnaround times.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	4	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	10	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	3	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	FTEs: paid vs. worked hours	One FTE is about 2,080 paid hours a year, but only the worked (productive) share covers the schedule; FTEs needed = worked hours needed ÷ worked hours per FTE.	Dividing required worked hours by 2,080 paid hours.	A worked-hours requirement and a nonproductive (PTO, education) share.
2	Leading vs. lagging indicators	Leading indicators change before the outcome and allow early action; lagging indicators report results after the fact.	Using last year's turnover rate as an early warning.	"Early warning" or "predict" versus "last year's result."
3	Valid benchmarking	Benchmark against comparable peers and adjust for size and case mix before drawing conclusions.	Comparing to any available average and declaring success.	A comparison group very different from the organization.
4	Stakeholder power-interest grid	High power/high interest: manage closely; high power/low interest: keep satisfied; low power/high interest: keep informed; low/low: monitor.	Treating every stakeholder the same way or ignoring power.	A stakeholder with authority but little day-to-day interest, or the reverse.
5	Productivity per unit of service	Hours per patient day (HPPD) = worked hours ÷ patient days; below the target means fewer hours than budgeted per unit.	Dividing patient days by hours or reading a lower HPPD as over budget.	Worked hours, patient days, and a target.
6	Vendor performance against the SLA	Measure a vendor against the specific service levels in its contract and use the contract's remedies when it falls short.	Judging vendors by relationship or reputation instead of contracted metrics.	A contract target and actual delivery counts.
7	RACI roles	Responsible does the work, Accountable (exactly one) owns the outcome, Consulted gives input before decisions, and Informed is told after.	Naming several people Accountable or confusing Consulted with Informed.	A RACI chart with multiple A's or a two-way versus one-way role.
8	Balanced scorecard perspectives	Measures fall into financial, customer, internal process, and learning and growth perspectives; workforce skills belong to learning and growth.	Filing every measure under financial because it affects cost.	A training, satisfaction, process, or margin metric.

Course scope (public description): Resource Management and Performance explores the management of human (internal and external) and physical to promote effective management at the department and organization levels. This course encompasses: effective utilization of resources, coordination of personnel and responsibilities, stakeholder identification (both individuals and entities. Students will also gain an understanding of healthcare performance measurement (key performance indicators (KPIs) in healthcare and their significance), techniques for measuring and benchmarking healthcare performance, and using data analysis to assess the performance of people/team, vendors, and the site (operational). There are no prerequisites to the course.